

The

Reckoner

of Marc Garneau C.I.

STEM: No Girls Allowed



Illustration: Joy Wang

By DANIEL PEKAR

A female friend of mine at Marc Garneau took a technology course and, by chance, ended up as the only female in that course. She did not think it would be a big deal; she was surprised when she found out that it was. Sexist remarks started to be thrown at her about how women do not belong in the field of technicians and mechanics. Adults would come in to the class and talk about how they remember days when girls used to sew instead of work with engines. Students would say, “Did cooking run out of spots?” and the teacher would remark, “Maybe someone should help do the lifting instead of her?” She told me that overall, the course is alright and the teacher is fine, but the sexist comments are definitely taking a toll on her enjoyment of the class.

Nevertheless, in recent years, studies have shown that an increasing amount of women are majoring in Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics [STEM] fields in university. University of Toronto boasts that 30% of first year engineers are women, with the percentage increasing every year. Females make up almost half the members in these fields, a number that has stayed nearly the same since 2002. Obviously, many of these women are trying to get jobs in the STEM workforce, yet for some reason make up only 39% of the workforce.

So what’s going on? Well, going back to the original anecdote, women working in STEM are being marginalized by a male-dominated workforce. According to a recent study by Center for Talent Innovation, women feel like they are depreciated by “lab-coat, hard-hat and geek workplace cultures” which often exclude women and show bias against them.

They also said that they feel “excluded from the ‘buddy networks’ created by their peers” and that they do not have as many female role models. Despite the fact that the women in this survey say they love the work and most were eager to do better, almost one-third say they did not think they are getting as far as they could because of sexism. Finally, the study found that women were almost half more likely to leave the industry than men.

This is a huge issue in the coming years, especially as these fields become more and more important in an increasingly electronic world.

This mentality is extremely prevalent in Marc Garneau. It’s hard to go a day without hearing a guy telling a “make me a sandwich” or “go back to the kitchen” joke. A constant reassurance that you are not fit to be doing what you are doing can have a large impact on someone. Even if it is just a joke, the veiled meaning that it conveys can manifest itself as something very real into the receiver. Everything you say can influence other’s feelings, which can affect decisions made later in life.

See STEM on P4

Four Portables Removed from MGCI’s Back Field



Four portables were removed from MGCI’s backfield this past summer. Photo: Sophia Liu

By XIN NIU ZHANG

Students who frequent Marc Garneau CI’s back field may have noticed a few differences since the end of the previous school year. This June, four portables were removed from the field, leaving behind a significant amount of additional open space.

According to school principal Ms. Goldenberg, overall enrollment has decreased slightly in the past several years. As a result, two portables were supposed to have been taken two years ago. Instead, a total of four portables were removed all at the end of the 2013-2014 school year and given new homes at other schools.

All four portables had been in use last year as classrooms. Although they weren’t strictly necessary, the extra portables made juggling class sizes much more manageable.

“We’re a little tight with classes this

year with the four of them gone,” said Ms. Goldenberg. “[They] just made it easier for us, but there were obviously schools that needed them.”

The loss of the portables, however, does open up new opportunities for the school in terms of athletics. When addressing overcrowding issues in the past, it had been pointed out how much of the field space was dedicated to housing the large number of portables. After the removal of four of these portables in June, the soccer goalposts were moved to increase the area of the track and soccer field to its proper size.

“There’s more available room, which is good since all of our class sizes are quite big,” said Ms. Libunao, a physical education teacher of Grade 9, 10, and 11 classes. “Our games are better.”

In the past, the field’s small size forced many varsity teams for sports

like soccer and field hockey to hold their practices at community parks such as Flemingdon. With the new field size, not only is the additional space useful for practices and gym classes, but the school is also able to host more home games.

However, now that the field is in higher demand, occasional conflicts can result between gym classes and the home games that are scheduled during school hours. Nevertheless, students are excited to have the new space.

“Doing home games in the past was kind of embarrassing,” commented Emily Ford, a Grade 12 student and member of the girls’ soccer team. “It’ll be really good now that we can actually hold proper games. The difference is really noticeable.” ■

Dr. Garneau Visits Garneau

By TAKHLIQ AMIR

The Marc Garneau C.I. library was silent during Periods 2, 3, and 4 on 3 October, 2014, as students awaited the arrival of Dr. Marc Garneau, the first Canadian to enter space and the man after whom MGCI is named.

On 5 October, 2014, Dr. Garneau celebrated the 30th anniversary of his first space flight. Initially a naval engineer, he was thirty-four when the astronaut program in Canada was created.

The world’s space program had begun in 1957, when the Soviet Union had launched the world’s first satellite, Sputnik 1, an event that led Canadian scientists to believe that they could build their own satellite and send it out into space to measure the occurrences in the night sky. Thus, the Alouette-1 was born.

“Canada is one of the leading space countries in the world. We have done an amazing number of things to contribute to the space programs of the world. The reason we went into space was because of the northern lights – the Aurora Borealis. Canadian scientists had looked up into the night sky and wondered what caused the lights to appear,” said Dr. Garneau.

In 1962, Canada finally went into space when the Alouette-1 was launched, the third country to do so after the Soviet Union and the United States. In 1984, the life of Dr. Garneau and the future of Canada’s space program changed as the first Canadian entered space.

When Dr. Garneau spoke of his experiences in outer space, he mentioned more than anything the great moments of reflection and contemplation on the fragility of our planet. He said, “Looking down at Earth gives a tremendously different feeling than looking at a picture. What this makes you realize, more than anything else, is that this is your planet, and that there are seven billion people in over two hundred countries that all call this planet home. It is the planet that we, all of us, share together, and that maybe we need to do a better job of taking care of it. You realize that there really is nowhere else for us to go. For better or for worse, we are humanity here on planet Earth. This is our planet, and when you look at it from space, you realize that you are not just Canadian, you are a member of Earth, and we all have to work together to save it.”

When asked whether one should try to improve Earth or find a new planet, Dr. Garneau replied, “I would like to think that we would find a way to keep this planet going, keep it healthy and peaceful. But at the same time, we should go out and look because I think there is a high probability that there is life out there. So let’s take care of our planet and let’s also explore the universe.”

Many students walked away with positive feelings from the presentation. Minhaz Rahman Khan, a Grade 12 stu-

dent who attended the presentation, said, “I thought the presentation was very educational and gave us a proper insight on what space life is like.”

Currently a Member of Parliament, Dr. Garneau tries to visit MGCI as often as possible. “Marc Garneau is a beautiful example of people of all ethnicities, cultures, religions, and beliefs working together and trying to live to similar values in terms of respecting the rights and freedoms of others,” he stated. ■



Dr. Garneau’s visit.
Guest photo: Natalie Mallari

Eid Mubarak, MGCI!

By TAKHLIQ AMIR

Large family gatherings, vibrant cultural dresses, and early morning prayers symbolized the celebration of Eid al-Adha for Muslims across all continents on the first weekend of October. This Eid, the second of two, is generally celebrated around the days 10 to 13 of the Islamic month of Dhu al-Hijjah (or Dhul Hijjah), and usually lasts for three days.

Also known as the “Feast of the Sacrifice,” Eid al-Adha is a commemoration of the struggles of prophet Abraham (Ibrahim) and his subservience to God, seen through his willingness to sacrifice his son Ismail to fulfill God’s command. According to Islamic tradition, around four thousand years ago, Allah (God) commanded prophet Abraham to sacrifice his own son, a beloved son that he had after having desired one for over several decades. Upon seeing that prophet Abraham’s loyalty and faithfulness towards Him superseded his love for his son, Allah replaced Ismail with a lamb that was sacrificed instead.

“It was a test of Prophet Abraham’s faith. When he continued with the sacrifice, he had passed God’s test. That’s why Eid is not just a time of celebration – it’s a replication of Prophet Ibrahim’s struggles and is symbolic of our past,” said Afrah Mubarak, a senior student at MGCI.

See EID on P4

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OP-ED

By DAVID LU

Election Day for our neighbors down south is fast approaching. On 7 November, 2014, control of the legislative branch of the United States Government will be decided at voting booths across America. The Republican Party, politically aligned with our Conservative Party, is predicted to gain control over Congress.

You may be thinking: “Why would I care about this? I live in Canada!” But let us take a closer look at the complex politics involved.

Congress has been deadlocked for the past four years, with the Republican Party holding firm control over the House of Representatives, and the Democratic Party edging out a slight majority in the Senate.

See REPUBLICAN on P4



The Immortal Warrior

By Hellen Li

CHICKEN SOUP FOR THE NUIT BLANCHE SOUL

By XIN NIU ZHANG

My first year at Nuit Blanche taught me four things.

1) We look a lot harder when we believe there's something we're supposed to see.

This is what most of us know about Nuit Blanche: It's an all-night contemporary art event, taking place in and transforming downtown Toronto.

Aha. "Contemporary art."

Hearing these words immediately ignite suspicion. After all, art itself can take any form, can be delivered to us through any medium—and, well, once we realize that it's not just art, but contemporary art, our suspicion inevitably jumps to a jittery paranoia.

We squint, warily, into the murky Toronto evening. After all, "art" can ambush us at any given moment, when we least suspect it. Ah! We see something! That's so cool! Is that—?

Nope, just a row of compost bins. One of them's tipped over.

How about—?

That's a bank. Okay.

Over one million people flood downtown Toronto for Nuit Blanche every year. Part of the fun of the event, really, is to watch these people flock to any perceived irregularities in the cityscape, so eager to bask in culture and creative expression and prove to their friends that they didn't just go for an excuse to

smoke pot and drink all night.

So, how do you differentiate art from accident? Is that giant lump of yellow LED lights in the middle of Fort York a breathtaking example of modern sculpture, or are the crowds just drawn to it like insects drawn to your brightly lit bedroom window in the middle of summer? Maybe it's all just a mindless, instinctual thing, and the near-zero night temperatures are getting to everybody's head. Your hands are too numb with cold to look for your program booklet to check if there's any exhibition resembling the bright bundle of lights in front of you. (For the record, that particular installation was literally called "Bright Bundle." Yes, it's that easy.)

Thankfully, you don't need to reach into your bag to check if something is "art" or not! Because, conveniently...

2) You can tell it's art because there'll be a sign saying so.

We live in a world reliant on labels. Thank God for that, too. How else would we be able to tell contemporary art from just a dude who decided to attach a rubber chicken to his bike?

The sign system for the Nuit Blanche exhibits is simple. Will there be anything of social relevance inside that museum building? If there's a sign telling you there is, then there you go!

But it's here that sophisticated culture

vultures face their next great obstacle—what exactly is the social relevance of a lady grinding out an endless chain of sausages in a caravan ("The Melodious Malfeasance Meat-Grinding Machine") outside of a hotel, looking like her fingers must be very horribly chapped and frozen? Well, that's the thing...

3) They provide the art. Hopefully, the viewers will make it into something meaningful.

Here's a neat little activity to do the next time you attend Nuit Blanche or visit your local art gallery. Absorb all that is esoteric, postmodern, tastefully ambiguous, and confusingly vague. Now spit all of that back out, making sure to attach to these pieces your very own intelligent, resonant, and original interpretations! Remember, "messages" sent by the art must be universal, enduring, and—of course—very incredibly deep. Relax. It's not that difficult. Just remember—when in doubt, all you need to do is mix in some phrases like "human nature" and "tragic fate."

For instance, the piece of performance art called "The sun will always rise and fall from east to west" is presented through a group of mysterious, dark-clad actors carrying large pieces of yellow cardboard cut in the shapes of a big circle and two thin triangles. The pairs carrying the two triangles represent "east" and "west" and the big yellow circle (the "sun," get it?) twirls around them as they play a clumsy game of tug-of-war. The whole affair lasts around eight minutes and of course there's a point to it. Obviously, it's a reflection of how humanity's interpersonal conflicts and attempts to disrupt nature have entrenched us in a vicious, predictable, and self-perpetuated pattern. The cyclical, self-destructive nature of the human condition is clearly represented by how the performances are repeated every half-hour throughout the night. Finally, as much as we understand that we are whirling headlong to our inevitable demise as a species, we cannot help but be mesmerized (for, like, at least eight minutes) by the disaster that we have created and so we continue to feed the fires of our fate.

Either way, nothing will change how hard I laughed when I saw a lady carrying a "Vote Olivia Chow!" sign walk primly down the street at 1 in the morning. I guess you just had to have been there.

Obviously,

4) I mean, it's not like anyone really cares about art anyway.

Let me say this again: Over one million people flood downtown Toronto for Nuit Blanche every year. You can't honestly believe that they're all here for the art, can you? Are there even one million people in Canada who like contemporary art? Are there even one million people alive who can claim to "get" it without being laughed at?

Joking aside, criticism of contemporary art and postmodernism is often redundant, boring, and overdone. Personally, I did not find the work presented at Nuit Blanche to be very compelling—but as an art un-enthusiast and clueless kid trying to have fun, that's perhaps to be expected. There were thousands of attendees similar to myself, and thousands more who really were just there to smoke pot and drink with their friends all night.

Is that wrong? Not necessarily. Does it reflect poorly on the nature of the event? Not at all!

Behind these pieces of art—which are presented with variable success to each individual—is an expansive event that is meant to be experienced holistically. Nuit Blanche provides a unique opportunity for us to engage with the city, with the city's people, and with the (possibly intoxicated) minds of the city's people. It opens up a channel for creativity and exploration. How many chances do we get to experience downtown Toronto on a Saturday night with one million others gathered for the same purpose?

Maybe "The Melodious Malfeasance Meat-Grinding Machine" is a politically charged symbol for the state of our economy. Maybe not. Maybe "Bright Bundle" is nothing more than a colossal waste of space, effort, and electricity, and will ultimately be the death of us all. Maybe not.

Either way, nothing will change how hard I laughed when I saw a lady carrying a "Vote Olivia Chow!" sign walk primly down the street at 1 in the morning. I guess you just had to have been there.

Misunderstood Idol

by MOUJAN SADERI

She walked down the dirt trail, and wandered deeper into the forest. Her worn brown boots crunched over the newly fallen leaves that littered the forest floor, and she sniffed as the cool autumn breeze made strands of her hair dance around her head. The trail ended as the forest gave way to a riverbed. Walking over to a nearby log, she sat down. Pulling out her sketchbook, the girl looked up at a tree across the river. It was her favourite tree. She must have drawn it at least twenty times already, but she still could not find a way to convey all that it represented.

The Jack Pine stood with its strangely twisted branches clutching its carefully sealed pine cones. They would remain closed until a forest fire sets the seeds inside free. She looked up at the crooked tree. That tree was everything she wished to be. She wanted to establish herself in the rocky soils where no other tree could stand. She wanted to grow tall and proud, confident in her own strength, even though her back was bent and her branches were spread across the sky at the oddest of angles. Most of all, she wanted to watch her home burn down all around her, and still be able to feel hope. She wanted to release her seeds even as her body crumbled away, still believing in a beautiful tomorrow.

The Jack Pine stood proudly, his branches silhouetted against the light of the setting sun. His seeds were hidden away from the light. They were weak. They were trapped. They wanted to be set free. They wanted to float through the fresh air and bury themselves in the soft earth. They wanted to live and to grow, but the Jack Pine hung onto them greedily. The Jack Pine was the most grand and majestic tree in the forest, with his powerful, curved body, and his marvelously contorted branches. He would not allow his seeds to escape. He could not risk one of them growing so tall that it rose above him and took his place. He had decided long ago, that he would rather burn than give the seeds a chance to grow.



Literacy Title TBD

By DAVID LI

In a school where 83.4 percent of students have English as their second language, and over one hundred and fifty dialects are spoken, having adequate English literacy skills has become an issue at Garneau.

The administration at Marc Garneau Collegiate Institute has attempted to tackle the issue regarding literacy in the school by mandating monthly cross-curricular literacy assignments. These assignments were put into place last year, and have shown to be useful for the students; the Ontario Secondary School Literacy Test scores for Marc Garneau have jumped eleven percent since the implementation of literacy assignments.[1]

However, the standardized literacy assignments throughout the school are becoming increasingly irrelevant and redundant due to the way they are structured and generalized to the student population. Students are treating

them as an assignment that needs to be done, and not taking literacy as something they need to constantly work on and improve on. The assignments themselves count towards a very thin slice of a student's mark in the course, although this factor remains an incentive to some. However, this rarely encourages students to put effort into developing their literacy skills.

Students are being handed assignments that are supposedly designed to help improve their literacy skills as well as prepare them for the Ontario Secondary School Literacy Test. Instead, students are being given assignments that force them to follow a strict outline in order to achieve a high mark on the test. While this works for the literacy test, it does not improve other literacy skills such as critical thinking and analysis. Giving the same assignments to students who have already passed the test is therefore redundant, since

they have already demonstrated they are able to meet what is required. The assignments end up becoming an exercise solely for improving marks for the literacy test even after students pass.

The formulaic assignments being mandated throughout the school are adequate for preparing students for the literacy test. However, the assignments do nothing for students who already have an understanding of the skills required to pass the literacy test. Instead, the school should provide general guidelines, rather than a single rubric, for teachers to cater to the needs of their own class. As teachers already know where their students are at in terms of literacy, they should create engaging and relevant assignments with the best interests of their students in mind. Students that take applied English courses will have different expectations and understandings than students who are in the academic English course. Asking both these groups to do the same assignments is ridiculous, and doesn't address the problems individual students may have regarding their literacy skills.

Literacy assignments should also be relevant towards each course, in an ideal blend of literacy practice and practical application of course content or research. Currently, literacy assignments are largely viewed as detached and separate from the course. In a perfect scenario, literacy assignments should be invisible to the student, in terms of its fluid implementation with regular coursework. Lab reports, reflective essays, and news articles related to the course topic are all examples of practical literacy in the curriculum

already. Ideally, these assignments should be presented in a manner such that students are aware of a literacy component, yet do not strictly view the assignment as literacy practice.

Students who have had customized literacy assignments that are relevant to the course have noticed a substantial difference. Mr. Melville and Mr. Mirza are both examples of teachers that have incorporated literacy skill development into their courses, but in a way such that students will be able to practice their literacy skills while reviewing or expanding on course material. Doing so makes these assignments dynamic to the students, who are in return more receptive.

Literacy at Marc Garneau is an issue, but it is one that students and teachers should work together to tackle. Students should be made aware of the importance of developing and refining literacy skills throughout their academic career. Literacy assignments, for their primary purpose of improving OSSLT results, have proven their effectiveness as seen by the recent jump in passing grades. However, using a highly structured, generic, and redundant assignment for the whole school as a means of collectively improving literacy is not the proper solution. Teachers should delve deeper into exactly what their students need in terms of literacy skills on a class-to-class basis, and optimize what they have to better suit their target audience.

[1] <http://www.tdsb.on.ca/Portals/o/AboutUs/Research/OSSLT-FTE2014.pdf>

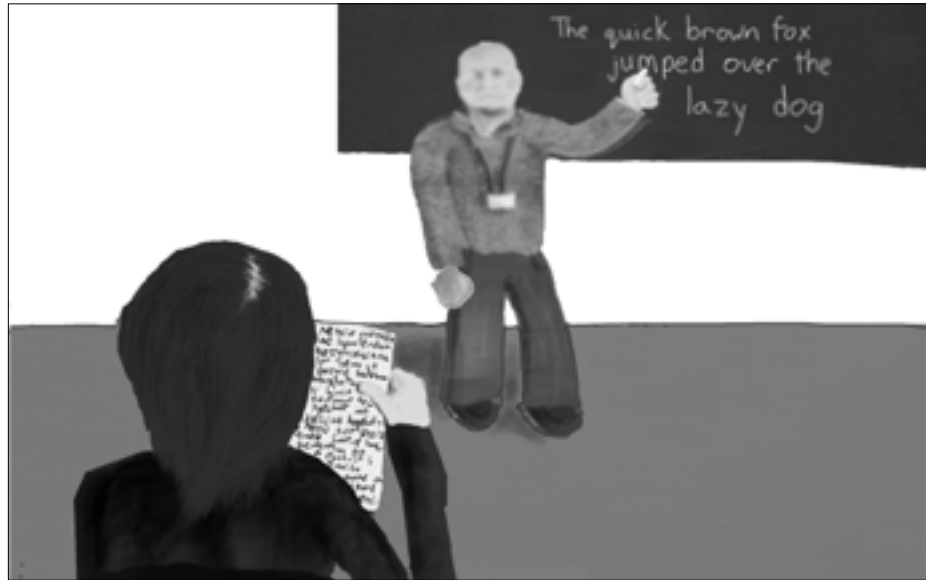


Illustration: Jeffrey Liu

STEM and Women

STEM CONTINUED from P1

In terms of a school wide solution, Marc Garneau should follow an approach pioneered by University of Toronto, with the Girls' Leadership in Engineering Experience program event. We have waiting lists that are far too long.

There is also no financial incentive to develop anything new. GLEE is an overnight stay at U of T where females going into engineering can talk to women who are already there, ask about what it is like and how they can approach going there. MGCI should also take a similar proactive stance. Programs that teach girls martial arts defense are accessible to MGCI students, so it's obvious that the faculty is willing to enact programs to help women. Why not have programs which help enable women to take more technology courses? Even if it is just a one-day event, it is a much needed encouragement for females interested but who might be unsure if it is right for them.

We think of this age as one that is very progressive, with social norms being challenged and old ideals being questioned. Nobody is going to say that only Jewish people belong in banks, or only Asians can do math. It is just as ridiculous to insist that only men belong in a STEM workforce.

The Republican Congress and You

REPUBLICAN OP-ED CONTINUED from P1

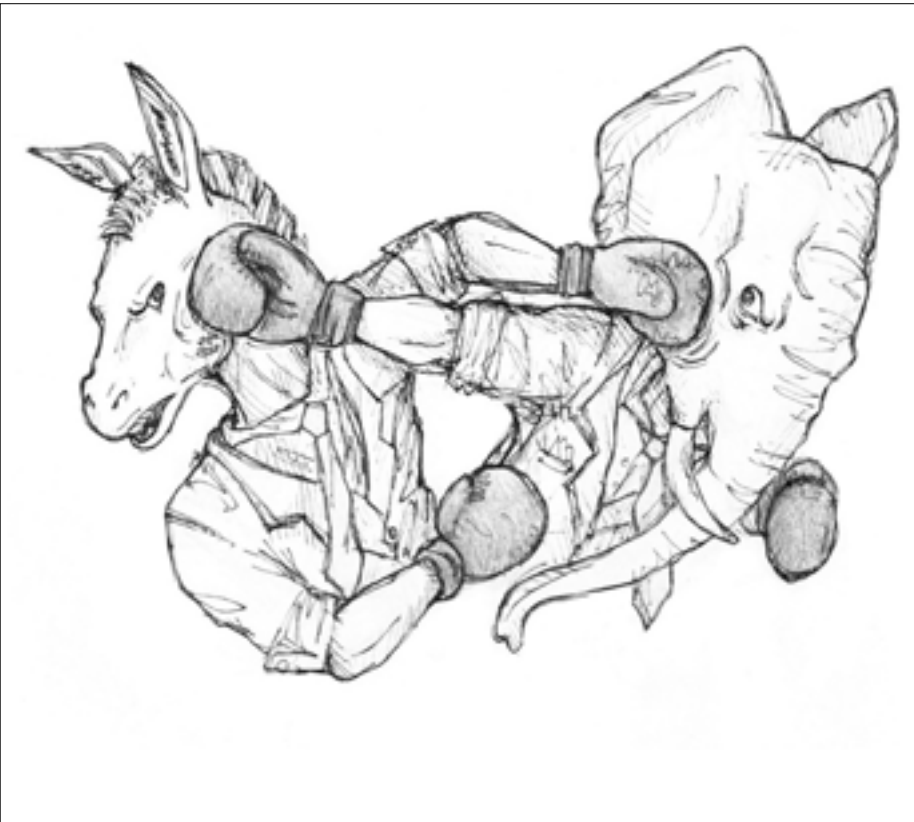


Illustration: Cathy Zhang

Congress is now a petty fistfight between the two parties. In fact, the last major bill, and primary election issue, is the Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act passed in 2010, otherwise known as Obamacare.

We Canadians enjoy our universal healthcare, but the majority of us are completely unaware of the subtle costs of our medical services. We pay high taxes on just about everything, especially in comparison to many other nations. Obamacare serves a similar but not all-encompassing purpose in the US. It created a great divide among the American public by cancelling more existing insurance policies than it provided, making health insurance man-

datory by setting a tax on non-compliance, and dissuading businesses and development by imposing compulsory employer insurance.

In practical terms, this means the average American will get his private insurance taken away, be forced to pay for a public plan (or get fined), and suffer under the failed bureaucracy known as the Obama Administration. As you can imagine, not too many happy American campers.

Many complaints have revolved around President Obama himself. He has purposefully lied about the Benghazi attack, where the US Ambassador to Libya and his security were attacked and murdered by Islamic extremists.

During sequestration, the Department of Defense was forced to cut billions to its spending, while Obama sent hundreds of millions to the Muslim Brotherhood terrorist group in Egypt. Obama selectively enforces laws, suing states for implementing laws he doesn't approve, and ignoring immigration laws by not prosecuting illegal immigrants. Obama released five high level Taliban prisoners for an American deserter. Many of these infractions can be impeachable.

Due to all of this, the Democratic ship will most likely sink in November. The Republicans need only six seats to gain a majority, and fifteen for a bullet-proof majority, something that can easily happen when Democratic senators lose elections in Republican states. But what does a Republican Congress mean for Canada?

Our economy will receive a boost, as the business friendly Republicans seek to further develop natural resources, agriculture, approve the Keystone XL Pipeline, and reduce Federal bureaucracy. All of which increase cross-border economic activity.

The reversal of defense budget cuts will lead to a more effective, strong, and respected US military. We do need some protection if the Russian Bears come knocking.

The repeal of Obamacare will serve as a wake-up call for our own healthcare reform. Who wants to wait in line for two-and-a-half years and then die before getting treatment?

In the end, a Republican victory in the November elections will be a symbol of change, from an ass to an elephant. A change that will renew America, and the world.



ASK THE RECKONER

How do you get over an existential crisis?
- Altor Istaca

Existing is not a simple concept. To address your question, the simplest way is to relieve yourself of absolute logic and place value materially (meaning anything in the external world). While it may appear that thought or consciousness is immaterial, they are shaped by motivation and emotion which are derived physically, by reacting to the environment. Firstly, you must find a purpose. Identify things that make you angry. If you fail to find anything, it means you have not read enough or you've become overly content. Invest in a noun, whether it is a cause, a person or a hobby. If your nihilism is rooted in depression, then check if you have some sort of malnutrition. Deficiency of B Vitamins and vitamin D are common culprits. Exercise is highly beneficial for depressive mindsets. Experiment with your activity and diet and find the best combination. However, if you find no external goal or purpose, you may find your willpower waning, causing you to succumb to nihilistic thoughts again. The temporary solution in this situation is simply to go to sleep.

If you want my personal opinion, think of this as an opportunity. The fact that you should have no existential restraint means that you can exist at a utilitarian mindset and use your time here to pursue careers and make decisions that will be of most benefit to other people. Or you may see yourself in a hedonistic mindset instead. No matter; intention is irrelevant as long as you produce heavily while consuming in reason. Be strong and make others proud.

Do you think NASA invented thunderstorms to cover up the sound of space battles?

- Google

No – beware the trap! For the government likes sheep but loves parrots more. Sheep follow and do not speak, but parrots trumpet the message of the government without discretion. You have – most unwittingly of course – become one of the parrots. The question sounds plausible, but it is the government itself which perpetuates this rumour. They are trying to distract you from the reality, which is that NASA is inventing thunderstorms to cover up the sound of space battles which themselves cover up the stage set at Area 51 where they faked the Moon Landings.

And now you know.

I really need math help, but I'm too embarrassed to admit it or ask someone. How do I deal with this?

- Rdu

There is nothing to be embarrassed about when looking for one-to-one help. You have to remember that everybody has their weaknesses and strengths, and that is perfectly natural. Moreover, many people in the world find math to be very difficult. You are not alone in your troubles – take consolation in that fact.

There is only one way to overcome a weakness, and that is to face it straight on. Avoiding the problem is not going to make it go away. So, if you want to become better at math, you have to practice. It's like exercising: work at it more to make your mathematic muscles ripped and powerful!

Teachers are a great resource. Use them. They are there to help you, and they're not going to judge you, or tell your classmates. Remember that it is not embarrassing to want to improve yourself – it is respectable.

If you seek counsel from The Reckoner like the individuals above, send us a question at

www.thereckoner.ca/ask-thereckoner



Photo: Jackie Ho

www.thereckoner.ca

Do you have a response to an article in this issue? Make your voice heard! Contact us at editor@thereckoner.ca.

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NEWS

A Community GEM

By RYAN LIN

In Flemingdon Park, there is a hidden gem, waiting to be discovered...in fact, there are many GEMs. GEM stands for Girls E-Mentorship, a charity founded by Rochelle de Goias to help girls who are disadvantaged or in poverty, by pairing them up with a mentor who is successful in the career they wish to pursue.

GEM started as a pilot program in 2013, with a total of twenty-two girls participating. Based on survey results and an interview process, they were introduced to high-achieving women in their fields of interest. The mentors act as role models and provide opportunities for the girls to experience the job hands-on, as well as providing career and education advice.

MGCI students Joyce Cheng, Selina McCallum, and Ameera Seiyad are currently interning at GEM. Selina McCallum, now the creative writing intern at GEM, spoke of her experience: “My mentor is a writer, Amoryn Engel, who works for National Post and Hello! Magazine. She took me to events with her and I got to write about them!” She

is also very grateful and insists that GEM “is an outstanding program that offers girls nothing but the best and encourages them to reach for their full potential.”

The program is open to all grade 11 and 12 girls that live in Flemingdon, Thorncliffe, and Regent Park, but there are plans for future expansion beyond these areas. Online applications usually begin around the end of August and close mid-September. Unfortunately, the program is no longer accepting applicants this year.

GEM is currently the only charity with access to the newly build Aga Khan Museum, and holds monthly workshops that range in topic from career training to yoga. GEM participants receive free memberships to the museum. The events are open to the entire community and are not just limited to the program. GEM also runs a blog covering topics such as career inspiration, health and fitness, and travel. More information about the events and program can be found at <http://girlsementorship.com/>.

Celebrating Eid

EID CONTINUED from P1

For many, the celebration is also marked by the sacrifice of goats, sheep and cows as a reminder of the Prophet Abraham’s trials and God’s mercy, after which the meat is divided into three sections: one-third to be retained by the family; one-third to be given to friends and neighbours; and the remaining third to be given to the poor.

Prophet Abraham’s devotion to Allah over his affection for his only son has since been celebrated by special prayers and large family gatherings throughout Muslim communities. Zoya Feza, a Grade 12 student celebrating Eid, said, “Muslims celebrate this wonderful occasion twice a year. As always, most of us will be celebrating it with our families and friends. Overall, waking up in the morning, going to Eid prayers and greeting everyone, is a feeling I don’t think anyone can even begin to describe. They’re beautiful moments.”

Saffiya Lulat, president of MGCI’s Muslim’s Student Association (MSA), said, “Eid is a celebration to remind us of the many sacrifices of our prophets and to remind ourselves that we shouldn’t love anyone more than God.

It is a time for us to get together with our friends and family and have a good time.”

Eid also marks the end of Hajj, the annual pilgrimage to Mecca that is mandatory for Muslims to carry out at least once in their lifetime. A five-day religious visit to the Grand Mosque in Mecca, Saudi Arabia – to the house of God – it is a very important part of the Islamic faith, representing the strong

belief in Allah of the Muslim people and their submission and deference to Allah.

The significance of Eid al-Adha is aptly expressed by the following phrase from the Quran, the holy book of Islam: “It is not their meat nor their blood that reaches Allah; it is your piety that reaches Him” (Qur’an 22:37). ■



Muslims pick out an animal to sacrifice to show how they are willing to sacrifice anything for God. Photo: Khadija Jawwad



Photos by Henry He and Khadija Jawwad
For more Humans of Garneau,
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“What are you smiling at?”

“My math test,” she said sheepishly.

“I used to be really lazy. I showed up late almost every day—teachers hated me. But this year I’m working so hard. My friends inspire me so much: I’m joining clubs, trying out for teams, studying and everything. I wanted to tell you this because I’m proud of myself and I’m happy I changed.”

“What’s something you’ve always wanted to do but never had the chance?”

“When I’m older, I’m gonna go out with my friends. A road trip across Canada maybe, and just chill.”



“How long have you been in Canada?”

“Two years.”

“Where are you from?”

“Korea.”

“Why’d you move here?”

“To study English.”

“Did you come with your family?”

“Yes, they did it for me.”

The Reckoner

of Marc Garneau C.I.

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